

Behind-the-Scenes Star Wars Collection Appears Online

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A collection of **behind-the-scenes** pictures and videos from special-effects artist Phil Tippett's film work has appeared on the Internet Archive. News of the collection circulated during the week before October 4, 2026, including a social media post on October 1.

Tippett and his team worked on films including Star Wars, Jurassic Park and RoboCop. He is especially known for using **stop-motion animation** to bring imaginary creatures to life. In stop motion, an object is moved a little between photographs. When the pictures play in order, the object seems to move.

The collection appears to come from a folder of CDs bought by an unnamed fan at a sale after Tippett's Berkeley, California, studio closed in August 2026. The buyer said they noticed that some material was not available online and wanted to **preserve** its **high-resolution** detail. They copied the contents and uploaded files representing 90 different discs.

The Star Wars material includes pictures from the making of the cantina scene in A New Hope, along with images of puppets and stop-motion creatures. There are also glimpses of the film's small holographic chess figures.

Other files show work on RoboCop, creature textures from Hellboy and computer **wireframe models** from Jurassic Park. The collection also includes photographs from animator Ray Harryhausen's 90th birthday.

Although his studio has closed, Tippett has said he is not quite ready to **retire**.

Word Treasure

behind-the-scenes -- Showing the work involved in making a film.

stop-motion animation -- An animation method in which objects are moved slightly between photographs that are played in sequence.

preserve -- Keep material so it remains available.

high-resolution -- Showing fine visual detail.

wireframe models -- Computer models shown as a framework of lines.

retire -- Stop working.

Break it down

Introduction: The collection appears on the Internet Archive and news spreads.

Context: Tippett's film work and stop-motion technique are explained.

Origin: The article describes the apparent CD source and the buyer's stated reason for uploading it.

Star Wars examples: Cantina pictures, puppets, creatures and holographic chess figures are listed.

Other examples: Material from RoboCop, Hellboy and Jurassic Park appears alongside birthday photographs.

Closing: Tippett comments on retirement after his studio's closure.

Why it matters

The uploaded collection provides a view of film-effects work and preserves material the buyer said was not already available online.

Test what you remember

1. **When did news of the collection circulate?**
 - (A) During the week before October 4, 2026
 - (B) Before the studio closed in August 2026
 - (C) During Ray Harryhausen's 90th birthday
 - (D) Only after October 4, 2026
2. **What did the buyer say they wanted to preserve?**
 - (A) The original cinema seats
 - (B) The material's high-resolution detail
 - (C) The studio building
 - (D) The sale's advertising posters
3. **Which description matches the reported source of the collection?**
 - (A) It was created for a new RoboCop film.
 - (B) It was filmed entirely on October 1.
 - (C) It appears to come from CDs bought by an unnamed fan.
 - (D) It definitely came directly from Ray Harryhausen.
4. **Which A New Hope scene is shown in the collection?**
 - (A) A forest battle
 - (B) A desert race
 - (C) A spaceship chase
 - (D) The cantina scene
5. **Which film's computer wireframe models appear in the files?**
 - (A) Hellboy
 - (B) RoboCop
 - (C) Jurassic Park
 - (D) A New Hope
6. **What personal celebration appears in the photographs?**
 - (A) The unnamed buyer's birthday
 - (B) The studio's opening celebration
 - (C) Ray Harryhausen's 90th birthday
 - (D) Phil Tippett's retirement party

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: C 4: D 5: C 6: C

Questions to think about

1. The unnamed buyer: The buyer said some material was unavailable online and wanted to preserve its high-resolution detail.
2. Phil Tippett: Despite his studio's closure, Tippett has said he is not quite ready to retire.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):